

# DBT Skills Workbook

Five small, practical skills for hard moments — use whichever fits.



- **Wise Mind** — notice emotion mind vs. reasonable mind
- **STOP** — the pause before you react
- **TIPP** — cool a spike down, fast
- **Opposite Action** — when the emotion doesn't fit the facts
- **PLEASE** — a basic-needs check-in

NOTICE WHERE YOU ARE

# Wise Mind Check-In

Emotion mind reacts. Reasonable mind analyzes. Wise mind is the quiet overlap — where feeling and logic meet.

**Emotion mind is saying...**

**Reasonable mind is saying...**

SETTLE HERE

**What does wise mind know, underneath it all?**

WHEN THINGS FEEL TOO BIG

# The STOP Skill

For the moment right before you react. Four small pauses.

## **S Stop**

freeze — don't act on the urge yet

for me, this looks like...

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## **T Take a step back**

pause, breathe, give yourself room

for me, this looks like...

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## **O Observe**

what's happening, inside and around you

for me, this looks like...

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## **P Proceed mindfully**

act with awareness, not impulse

for me, this looks like...

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FOR WHEN IT'S TOO MUCH, TOO FAST

# TIPP: Cool It Down Fast

Body-based skills that work quickly. Jot your go-to version of each.

## **T** Temperature

cold water on your face or hands

my go-to...

## **I** Intense exercise

a few minutes to burn off the surge

my go-to...

## **P** Paced breathing

exhale longer than you inhale

my go-to...

## **P** Paired muscle relax

tense, then release, one group at a time

my go-to...

## WHEN THE EMOTION DOESN'T FIT THE FACTS

# Opposite Action

Emotions come with built-in urges. Acting opposite to the urge is sometimes what actually helps.

### THE EMOTION

what am I feeling?

### THE URGE

what does it want me to do?

### THE OPPOSITE ACTION

what's one small opposite move?

## TAKING CARE OF THE BASICS

# PLEASE: A Steadier Baseline

Emotions are harder to manage on an empty tank. A quick, honest check on the basics — not perfectly, just honestly.

### **PL** treat Physical illness

any aches, meds, or care I'm putting off?

for me, this looks like...

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### **E** balanced Eating

have I eaten today, roughly on time?

for me, this looks like...

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### **A** Avoid mood-altering substances

anything I'm leaning on more than usual?

for me, this looks like...

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### **S** balanced Sleep

how has sleep actually been?

for me, this looks like...

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### **E** get Exercise

any movement today, even a little?

for me, this looks like...

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